

Each city then functions as an individual entity, and this means your empire consists of many individual cities. This also means that you have to defend cities as individuals, and your foes will attack one city at a time—or many foes will attack many cities at once.

RON also includes technological research that defines how fast you can get to modern-day weaponry and technology, all housed under one building. So there's no frantic clicking on different buildings to look for missed threads in your research, which then hold you back from advancing to the next technological age. For most AOE-type strategy players, this feature was a gift from the heavens!

Like *Age of Empires*, RON features eight ages that you progress through: classical, mediaeval, gunpowder, enlightenment, industrial, modern, and information. So you go from a wandering nomadic tribe to a civilisation with the power to blow your opponents away with nukes!

RON also has a single-player mode, where you start as one country and the computer controls all the others. Your task is to take over the world, one country at a time! This task switches between turn-based strategy and real-time strategy, depending on whether you're invading or being invaded—or just researching technologies. In order to take over a country you have to complete a specified task, which could be as simple as obliterating the enemy or withstanding half an hour of a barbarian attack, and so on.



*Rise Of Nations* takes you from a nomad to a nuclear superpower